COOKIES & BARS · SWEET

Minty Lime Bars

Lime-mint shortbread under baked lime curd, chilled and cut.

MAKES 16 BARS · **ACTIVE** 50 MIN
TOTAL 1 HR 45 MIN, PLUS COOLING AND 1 HR CHILL
PAN 8 X 8 IN, METAL PREFERRED
OVEN 350°F (175°C), THEN 300°F (150°C)

BEFORE YOU START

- Rack in the center; preheat the oven to **350°F** (**175°C**).
- Line the pan with two crossed sheets of foil pressed into the corners and up the sides, then butter the foil. The overhang becomes handles for lifting the bars out.
- Zest the limes for the crust (and a little extra for serving) before juicing them.
- Keep both portions of butter cold until they go in. Have an instant-read thermometer ready for the curd.

INGREDIENTS

Shortbread crust

		Butter for the pan
	2 Tbsp	Finely grated lime zest about 3 limes
50 g	1/4 cup	Granulated sugar
130 g	1 cup	All-purpose flour
	2 Tbsp	Fresh mint finely chopped
	1/4 tsp	Baking powder
	pinch	Diamond Crystal kosher salt
113 g	1 stick	Unsalted butter cut into 1/2-inch pieces, chilled

Lime curd

170 g	3/4 cup	Fresh lime juice about 7 limes
57 g	1/4 cup	Fresh lemon juice about 1 large lemon
3 g	1 tsp	Cornstarch
	pinch	Diamond Crystal kosher salt
200 g	1 cup	Granulated sugar divided
80 g	5	Large egg yolks
50 g	1	Large egg
85 g	6 Tbsp	Unsalted butter cut into pieces, chilled

To finish

Powdered sugar and lime zest for serving

METHOD

Crust

1. Rub the lime zest into the sugar with your fingertips until damp and fragrant. Toss in the flour, mint, baking powder and salt.

2. Add the cold butter and toss to coat, then smash and pinch it in with your fingertips.
   ✓ *Moist crumbs that clump when squeezed*

3. Scatter the crumbs in the pan and press into an even layer, right into the corners and against the sides. Bake at **350°F** (**175°C**).
   WAIT 25 TO 30 MIN
   ✓ *Lightly golden*

4. Lower the oven to **300°F** (**150°C**) and let the crust cool while you make the curd.

Curd

5. In a small saucepan, combine the lime juice, lemon juice, cornstarch, salt and half the sugar (100 g). Heat over medium, whisking now and then to dissolve the sugar. Once boiling, whisk constantly for about **1 min** until slightly thickened, then take off the heat.

6. Only once the citrus is boiling, whisk the yolks, whole egg and remaining 100 g sugar hard for about **1 min**. Combining them any earlier can make the curd lumpy.
   ✓ *Smooth, thick and a couple of shades paler*

7. Whisking the whole time, drizzle the hot citrus into the eggs a tablespoon at a time until about half of it is in.

8. Whisk everything back into the saucepan and cook over medium-low, whisking constantly, **3 to 5 min**.
   ✓ *Opaque, coats a spoon, holds whisk marks,* **170°F (77°C)**

9. Off the heat, whisk in the butter one piece at a time, letting each melt before adding the next, until smooth.

Bake and finish

10. Pour the hot curd over the crust and shake the pan to level it. Bake at **300°F** (**150°C**).
    WAIT 30 TO 35 MIN
    ✓ *Sides puffed, center set but still slightly wobbly*

11. Cool completely in the pan, then refrigerate.
    WAIT ABOUT 1 HR IN THE FRIDGE
    ✓ *The bottom of the pan is cold*

12. Lift the slab out by the foil, peel the sides down and slide a spatula underneath to free the crust. Cut into 16 squares. Dust with powdered sugar and lime zest just before serving.

NOTES

Make ahead & storage

- Bars keep airtight in the fridge up to **5 days**, best on day 1 or 2. Add the sugar and zest only at serving.
- The crust can be baked a day ahead and kept wrapped at room temperature.
- The curd can be made up to **3 days** ahead. Store it in plastic or glass, not stainless (it picks up a tinny taste), with wrap pressed onto the surface. Bring to room temperature and whisk loose before using.

Substitutions

- As a tart: press the shortbread into the bottom and up the sides of a buttered, unlined 9-inch removable-bottom tart pan, smoothing it with the base of a 1-cup measure. It will feel crumbly; just close any gaps. Parbake as written, fill (there may be curd left over) and bake **35 to 40 min**, until set with a slight wobble in the center.
- Sweet Tart Dough, parbaked, also works as the tart shell.

Pairs with

- Chocolate Pavlova (a use for the 5 leftover whites)

My notes

- Made 7/4/26. So good with about 10 mint leaves.
- The curd is easy; just prep everything ahead.
- Try lemon zest in the shortbread for less tartness.

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SWEET
CITRUS · TANGY · MINT · MAKE-AHEAD
USES EGG YOLKS

Adapted from Dessert Person by Claire Saffitz, pp. 155 to 156. Method rewritten and condensed for personal kitchen use.